

AI-Relevance for ESDC

Operationalizing the Government of Canada x Coveo MOU at Employment and Social Development Canada

Franck Benichou · Forward Deployed Engineer candidate

-  Live app · pokemon-search-one-chi.vercel.app
-  GitHub · github.com/benichou/coveo-pokemon-challenge
-  RGA performance monitoring · pokemon-rga-dashboard.vercel.app
-  Query observability · [grafana public dashboard](https://grafana-public-dashboard)

Three signals · why ESDC EI · why now

ESDC EI sits at the intersection of three independent timing signals — making **AI-Relevance the right fit, not just a possible fit.**

01

ESDC EI scale & operational headroom

- ~39,150 ESDC employees · ~2,625 EI call-centre agents
- 2-3.1M EI claims/year · ~\$14.3B paid annually
- 20-25M+ calls/year · bilingual FR/EN mandate
- Peak wait times >1h · claim processing 17-18 days vs 28-day standard

Zero operational headroom · every point of agent efficiency is consequential.

02

BDM Programme phasing · EI is Phase 2

- Benefits Delivery Modernization unifies OAS · GIS · CPP · EI · target 2030
- OAS (Phase 1) migrated to BDM platform 2023-2025 ✓
- EI (Phase 2) · migration window 2025-2028
- First EI release (Benefits Estimator) in beta 2024 · build phase began 2025
- Current EI search: keyword-only · 50-year-old system · 6 RPA bots in call centres

EI migration is already in flight · AI-Relevance layers on top of BDM, not against it.

03

GoC x Coveo MOU · signed Dec 17, 2025

- 5-year framework via Ministers Lightbound + Solomon
- Signed through SSC (Shared Services Canada) + ISED (Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada)
- MOU names: enterprise search · generative + agentic AI · call-centre answers · self-serve services
- Têtu (Coveo): "multi-billion-dollar opportunity in the Canadian government"

ESDC EI is the natural first concrete application of the framework.

The question isn't *should ESDC adopt AI-Relevance?* · it's which EI workflow lands first, and on what timeline?

AI-Relevance for ESDC EI · reuse what's built

Five **AI-Relevance™** pillars · four shipped patterns adapt to ESDC · delivered by **1-2 embedded FDEs**.

 Intent modeling (not keyword)

 Behavioral ML ranking

 BYO-LLM sovereign-flexible

 MCP-ready agent surface

 Canadian-HQ infrastructure

▷ POKÉMON

Quality + tuning loop

100-Q golden · Sonnet · 5 guardrails



▷ ESDC EI

Bilingual eval + quality + compliance

~250-Q FR/EN · per-program slices · A/B rollout

▷ POKÉMON

Dual-source ingestion

Sitemap + Push · 1,353 docs unified



▷ ESDC EI

Policy + BDM content layer

Procedures + BDM push · Security Identities

▷ POKÉMON

Headless + React detail page

3 parallel queries · hero · passages · related



▷ ESDC EI

EI agent decision-support

3 parallel calls · claim · policy · related

▷ POKÉMON

Coveo MCP Server

4 tools · search · fetch · passages · answer



▷ ESDC EI

2027-2030 AI-client path

Officer Copilot · LLM voice IVR · citizen chat



▷ DELIVERY MODEL

1-2 FDEs embedded with ESDC BDM teams · configure · adapt · train · document. The bridge between Coveo's platform and ESDC's policy / bilingual / compliance reality.

| Before vs After · two EI workflows

Same officer · same case · with **Coveo AI-Relevance**, search collapses, citations get captured automatically, and edge cases get the senior-officer answer every time.



Claim Processing Centre

EI Processing Officer reviewing an EI claim

BEFORE AI-RELEVANCE

- Open case in legacy management system
- Read ROE data · **keyword-search the policy DB** (typo? guess the right section?)
- Switch tabs: procedures · prior claims · federal-provincial overlap rules
- Re-paste citations into case notes by hand
- Edge case? Hold the case · escalate to a senior officer

WITH COVEO AI-RELEVANCE

- ✓ Open case → **detail page loads in <1s**: claim summary + policy excerpts + similar past cases (3 Coveo calls in parallel)
- ✓ Edge case? **Type the question · RGA grounded answer + citations** in 2-3s
- ✓ Citation **auto-captured** in case notes (audit-ready)
- ✓ Decision documented · escalations rare · same answer every time



EI Call Centre

Call-Centre Agent on a citizen call

BEFORE AI-RELEVANCE

- Citizen calls · agent listens · opens citizen account
- **Keyword-searches** legacy policy DB while citizen waits ("let me check that...")
- Switches between case mgmt · procedures · ROE history
- Complex case → hold · escalate to supervisor
- After call: documents call from memory · separately

WITH COVEO AI-RELEVANCE

- ✓ Citizen account **pre-loaded** from caller ID + recent context
- ✓ Agent types brief question · **RGA answers in 2-3s with citation**
- ✓ Agent paraphrases confidently · citation auto-captured in call notes
- ✓ **First-contact resolution lifts** · escalations drop · consistent answers across agents

| Disciplined AI-Relevance delivery · industry-grade outcomes

Keyword → AI-Relevance · bigger than typical RAG-to-AI-Relevance · FDE bridges pilot-to-production.

▸ ANCHOR 1

Built every layer myself

All layers in the public repo. **Code shipped, not pitched.**

▸ ANCHOR 2

Measurement-first discipline

First ship: the **bilingual eval** · proves new RGA > today's keyword.

▸ ANCHOR 3

Operated inside ESDC via EY

EY Canada · ESDC EI · first-gen RAG. Policy + bilingual + workflows known · **short ramp.**

▸ SYSTEM-DESIGN OUTCOMES · defensible by architecture

Regressions: weeks → **<24h**

Citations: manual → **100% auto**

Bilingual: invisible → **continuous**

Audit: ad-hoc → **by design**

▸ INDUSTRY-GRADE OUTCOMES · refined vs ESDC baseline in first 90 days

-15 to -25%

Average Handle Time (call centre)

-20 to -35%

Time-to-resolution · complex cases

-30 to -50%

New officer/agent ramp time

▸ FIRST 30 DAYS I'D ASK FOR

- **Baseline:** EI search metrics + officer feedback
- **Stakeholders:** DG Service Delivery · Policy Owner · Security/Compliance
- **Pilot:** one EI sub-workflow (maternity benefits)

Thank you · Q&A

Keyword → AI-Relevance · disciplined delivery · industry-grade c

1-2 embedded FDEs · BDM-aligned · measured against ESDC's own baseline

-  Live app · pokemon-search-one-chi.vercel.app
-  GitHub · github.com/benichou/coveo-pokemon-challenge
-  RGA performance monitoring · pokemon-rga-dashboard.vercel.app
-  Query observability · [grafana public dashboard](https://grafana-public-dashboard)

Appendix · Risk register

Honest CIO-grade risks · pre-prepared mitigations · pull up if Q&A goes there.

▸ Vendor lock-in

Mitigation: Index exportable · LLM is BYO · closed-loop code in our repo · golden set is our IP

Residual: re-implementing full stack elsewhere ≈ 6-12 months

▸ Data sovereignty

Mitigation: Canadian-region deployment · Coveo HQ Montréal · source content can stay on-prem via Crawling Modules

Residual: verify Canadian-region SLA contractually

▸ Compliance accountability

Mitigation: 100% audit trail · per-decision citations · officer-in-the-loop (not citizen-facing in Phase 1)

Residual: citizen could misinterpret officer-paraphrased answer

▸ LLM cost volatility

Mitigation: BYO-LLM lets us switch providers · already on cost-efficient model (Sonnet) · A/B for cost-quality tradeoffs

Residual: quarterly budget review required

▸ Workforce displacement concerns

Mitigation: Officer augmentation framing · same headcount + higher service standards · no replacement narrative

Residual: PSAC (union) engagement non-negotiable

▸ BDM integration collision

Mitigation: Adjacency, not collision · agent/decision-support layer alongside BDM core transformation · same content, different access path

Residual: BDM PMO coordination overhead in months 0-6

Appendix • References

Every claim in the deck links to a public source • pre-panel re-verification recommended.

▸ ESDC + GOVERNMENT OF CANADA

GOC x COVEO MOU (DEC 17, 2025)

- [Canada.ca • MOU announcement](#)
- [Canada.ca • MOU backgrounder](#)
- [BetaKit • 5-year MOU coverage](#)

BDM PROGRAMME

- [Auditor General Report 8 • BDM Programme](#)
- [ESDC briefing • March 2025](#)
- [ESDC briefing • May 2025](#)

EI OPERATIONS + SCALE

- [EI Monitoring 2024 • Ch 4 \(incl. 6 RPA bots\)](#)
- [ESDC main](#)

▸ COVEO + POKÉMON BUILD

COVEO AI-RELEVANCE™ POSITIONING

- [coveo.com • AI-Relevance Platform](#)
- [Coveo IR • GoC partnership](#)
- [Coveo customers](#)

COVEO BRAND ASSETS (LOGOS)

- [Coveo Media Kit](#)
- [ESDC logo • Wikimedia \(public domain\)](#)

POKÉMON BUILD • THE LIVE PROOF

- [Atomic main app](#)
- [GitHub repo](#)
- [RGA performance dashboard](#)
- [Grafana query observability](#)